

Ernest SONG ♦ Director of Finance

📍 Rue Montagne de l'Oratoire 28/76

B-1000 Brussels

✉ contact@ernestsong.com

🌐 ernestsong.com

☎ +32 476 60 05 90

Director-level finance leader with 15+ years owning financial controlling, P&L-adjacent mandates and the financial close across multi-entity, multi-country operations in BE, FR and NL. As a Director of Finance I take end-to-end stewardship of the numbers: dependable financial reporting (MS Power BI, Cognos), disciplined budgeting and forecasting, and reliable month-end close from AS-IS diagnosis to SAP S/4HANA go-live. I partner with executives as a strategic finance lead, turn results into decisions, and keep calm under pressure to turn finance into a lever for growth.

Education

ESCP Business School

(#1 FT 2026)

2010 – 2011 | Paris, FR

Specialized Master's degree

Auditing and Consulting

Université Paris Nanterre

2005 – 2010 | Paris, FR

Master's degree

Management Science and Financial Control

Competencies

Business

- MS Office (advanced Excel, Power Query)

ERP

- SAP HANA

Business Intelligence

- MS Power BI
- QlikSense
- Business Object
- Cognos
- Hyperion

RPA

- UiPath
- MS PowerAutomate

Agile

- Jira
- Confluence

Data & Analytics

- VBA
- SQL
- R

Languages

Native: French, Khmer, Teochew

Proficient: English

Basics: Dutch (A2), Spanish, Mandarin

Interests

Sustainable development, Powerlifting, Mountain biking, Tennis

Interpersonal

Fast-learner, Problem solver, Diplomacy, Driven, Autonomous, Teamplayer

Professional Experience

Engie SEM

January 2026 – Present | Brussels, BE

Strategic Business Analyst & Finance Automation Lead (Freelancer)

- Owned financial controlling for the SAP S/4HANA migration pilot across French subsidiaries, bridging IT architecture and strategic business operations to keep the go-live on schedule.
- Built an automated budgeting and forecasting tool from scratch within a 2-week staffing gap, restoring operational continuity and replacing an unreliable legacy spreadsheet.
- Automated the financial close for commodity trading with PowerQuery ETL workflows, ingesting 1,500+ bookings per close with zero manual intervention.
- Reconciled middle-office (IVDB) and SAP S/4HANA data while simplifying WBS project codes to strengthen portfolio monitoring.

Holcim

January 2024 – December 2025 | Nivelles, BE

Senior Operational Excellence & Data Lead (Freelancer)

- Translated market-analysis data into restructured production workflows post-M&A, lifting operational efficiency.
- Directed the SAP HANA migration, preserving data integrity across the consolidated group.
- Built rebate models (matrix & automated SAP) aligned to commercial strategy.
- Deployed QlikSense for financial reporting, converting raw data into executive insights.
- Guaranteed data reliability and audited rebate matters with external auditors.

Engie Tractebel

March 2023 – December 2023 | Brussels, BE

Cash Flow & Financial Modeling Specialist (Freelancer)

- Produced per-project cash-flow reporting and cash-exposure analysis to support working-capital decisions.
- Assessed financing needs, conducted counterpart credit analysis and impairment testing.
- Built financial models from SAP and delivered Power BI dashboards for finance reporting.

Shurgard

February 2022 – February 2023 | Brussels, BE

Investment & Corporate Development Analyst (Freelancer)

- Analyzed and managed real-estate projects (construction, redevelopment, acquisitions) across the self-storage portfolio.
- Ran project dashboards and advanced corporate-development initiatives to improve policies and procedures.
- Designed the data model and BI visualizations for the Investment department.
- Contributed to an AI-powered pricing model.

Magnetrap

November 2020 – January 2022 | Mons, BE

Freelance CFO / Fundraising Consultant

- Served as interim CFO and raised €3M in debt/equity, funding growth milestones.
- Built cash-flow projections, business plans and multi-year financial targets.
- Monitored KPIs and applied corrective actions to protect profitability.
- Prepared operating-results reporting and sustained financial models for long-term planning.

Tobania

February 2020 – October 2020 | Brussels, BE

Director Business Process Automation

- Rolled out a citizen-developer model with RPA and self-service BI, defining pricing strategy and roadmap.
- Owned business development (marketing, pre-sales, sales) and opened new revenue opportunities.
- Standardized and harmonized processes to raise efficiency and customer profitability.
- Delivered tailored cost-control reporting and established change-management structures to drive adoption.

Soap collect

January 2019 – Present | Phnom Penh, KH

Founder

- Founded a non-profit delivering hygiene products to disadvantaged communities.
- Partnered with luxury hotel chains to source used soap for reconditioning.

Degroof Petercam

January 2018 – December 2018 | Brussels, BE

Performance Management Project Leader

- Drove the Finance Transformation Operating Model (FTOM) engagement.
- Launched a client-centric performance management system.
- Optimized the finance-close process to strengthen governance, internal control and data quality.
- Led regulatory-reporting sourcing initiatives against BPM standards.
- Ran gap analyses to prioritise process improvements.

Vinci Airports

February 2016 – December 2017 | Brussels, BE & Lisbon, PT

Managing Director & Head of Project Financial Modeling / Cursus Grand Talent

- Delivered value creation with valuation at 4× acquisition cost.
- Coordinated airport operations across 50+ sites in multiple countries.
- Built multi-year financial models capturing macroeconomic impact, capex and concession valuation.
- Negotiated concession extension and rolled out a new model to improve budgeting and forecasting.
- Managed accounting and financial reporting to BE-GAAP standards.

Rexel

September 2014 – January 2016 | Paris, FR

Reporting Consolidation Manager

- Led IFRS financial reporting for Asia-Pacific, Latin America and Canadian subsidiaries.
- Integrated SAP BPC and Cognos reporting across the group.
- Ran annual budgeting, monthly forecasting and variance analysis.
- Led the strategic planning process.

KPMG Audit

January 2011 – August 2014 | Paris, FR

Financial Auditor Supervisor

- *Audited financial statements under multiple standards, testing key processes against SOX.*
- *Audited financial modeling for long-term PPP contracts.*
- *Certified FP7 grant agreements and led audit teams supervising financial auditors.*
- *Expanded partnerships into new markets to drive business growth.*

Main sector: Construction (Vinci, Eiffage, Colas), Real estate (Nexity), Water distribution (Veolia), International parcels distribution (Geopost from La Poste group), Security (Brink's), Healthcare (DomusVie).

ICM - Brain & Spine Institute

November 2009 – August 2010 | Paris, FR

Deputy CFO Trainee

- *Implemented the budget system and prepared business plans for the scientific teams.*
- *Built internal controls for purchasing and donation processes and managed bank reconciliation.*
- *Prepared the institutional audit necessary for the certification by the "Comité de la Charte".*